

Second helping

Cows eat grass without chewing it properly. It goes to the rumen and reticulum to be broken down into cud. The cow coughs this up and chews it again. When it is swallowed, the cud goes through the stomachs in turn, being finally digested in the abomasum.

Animals that chew cud are called ruminants.

Abomasum

This is the udder, where the milk is produced. It is in four parts. Each part has a teat.



In the milking parlor

When cows are milked, special suckers are attached to the teats. They squeeze the milk gently from the cow just like a calf does. A cow can give between 7 and 9 gallons of milk every day.

Dairy cattle



Holstein Friesian



Jersey

Beef cattle

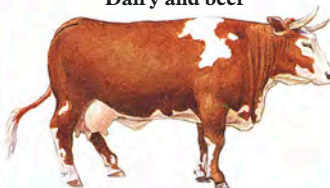


Hereford



Charolais

Dairy and beef



Simmental



Bred for beef

Big, heavy breeds of cattle are kept for beef because they have more meat on them. The world's largest herds of beef cattle are found in North and South America. Here there are lots of wide-open spaces where the cattle can graze until they are fat and ready for eating.

